



King County Library System

Board of Trustees Meeting Minutes

KCLS Service Center/Hybrid | December 19, 2025, 5pm

Present

KCLS Board

Crystal Goodwin
Jeffery Guddat
Harish Kulkarni
Srinu Raghavan
Verna Seal*
Laura Valenziano

KCLS Staff

Angie Benedetti
BJ Colvin
Heidi Daniel
Lisa Fraser
Chase Gallagher
Dominica Myers
Danielle Perry
Cecie Streitman
Lisa Yamasaki
Donna Zirkle

**attended remotely*

Motions Approved

1. Board Meeting agenda
2. November 19, 2025 Board meeting minutes
3. Payroll expenditures
4. General Fund expenditures
5. Resolution 2025-06 Adoption of 2026 Budget

Call to Order

President Laura Valenziano called the meeting to order at 5:03pm. Jeff Guddat, Srinu Raghavan, Harish Kulkarni and Crystal Goodwin attended in person; Verna Seal attended online. There was a quorum.

Approval of Agenda

Jeff Guddat moved approval of the Board Meeting agenda. Verna Seal seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.

Approval of Board Minutes

Srinu Raghavan moved approval of the November 19, 2025 Board Meeting minutes. Harish Kulkarni seconded the motion. All voted in favor and the motion passed unanimously.

Public Comment

There was no public comment.

Human Resources Report

General Wage Increase

Human Resources Director Danielle Perry presented a recommendation for a 3% general wage increase for non-represented staff, effective Jan. 1, 2026, to align with the increase being provided to represented staff. The recommendation is based on labor market comparisons, inflation and consumer prices, minimum wage rates, collective bargaining commitments, and the overall fiscal environment. Danielle clarified that the increase is a general wage adjustment and not a cost-of-living increase.



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Action Item

Crystal Goodwin moved approval of the General Wage Increase of 3% for all non-represented KCLS employees as presented by Danielle Perry. Jeff Guddat seconded the motion. All voted in favor and the motion passed unanimously.

Finance and Facilities Report

Finance and Facilities Director Donna Zirkle presented the monthly Finance report as of the end of November 2025. Year-to-date (YTD) revenues were \$149.9M, against the yearly revenue budget of \$150.6M which was approximately 99%. YTD expenses were \$136.3M, which is 83% of the total expense budget of \$164.6M. CIP expenses YTD at the end of November were \$7.4M accounting for 59% of the total budget of \$12.5M.

Donna Zirkle introduced Resolution 2025-06, Adoption of the 2026 Budget. The final budget includes key investments in staff, library materials and services, and building maintenance, and requires the use of \$10.4 million in reserves. She reviewed minor changes from the preliminary budget presented in October, including a \$52,000 decrease in projected revenue and an \$811,000 decrease in projected expenses.

Donna provided a high-level overview of budgeted revenue and expenses. Projected revenue totals \$155 million, consisting of 94% property tax revenue and 6% from other sources, including grants, investment interest, and E-rate subsidies. Projected expenses total \$165.4 million, allocated as follows: 60% public services, 31% administrative services, and 9% capital investment plan.

Major projects planned for 2026 include completion of the central sorter replacement project, two automated materials handling system upgrades, two roof replacements, one HVAC replacement, and interior facility refreshes.

Approval of Monthly Expenditures

Crystal Goodwin moved approval of Payroll expenditures for November in the amount of \$3,571,755.63: (11/07) Ck#00202582-00202597; 152574187-152575333; (11/20) Ck#00202598-00202612; 164026187-164027310. **Verna Seal seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.**

Srini Raghavan moved approval of General Fund #0010 expenditures for November in the amount of \$6,861,373.63: Travel Advances – 0; (11/13) Ck#5015877-5015930; 1163077-1163209; (11/20) Ck#1163210-1163339; 5015931-5015934; (11/24) Ck#1163340-1163341; (11/26) Ck#5015935; 1163342-



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1163436; (12/04) Ck#1163437-1163559; 5015936-5015942. Voids - 0. **Harish Kulkarni seconded, and the motion passed unanimously.**

Jeff Guddat moved approval of Resolution 2025-06 Adoption of the 2026 Budget. Crystal Goodwin seconded. All voted in favor and the motion passed unanimously.

Election of 2025 Board Officers and Committee Members

The trustees unanimously agreed that Laura Valenziano will serve as Board president and Jeff Guddat will serve as Board secretary in 2026, extending the officers' terms to two years, rather than the previous one-year practice.

The trustees agreed that the Board committees will be as follows:

- **Finance:** Crystal Goodwin, Laura Valenziano, Jeff Guddat
- **Board Development:** Srinu Raghavan, Harish Kulkarni, Laura Valenziano
- **eBook ad-hoc:** Verna Seal, Harish Kulkarni, Laura Valenziano
- **KCLS Foundation Liaison:** Harish Kulkarni

The trustees also approved the 2026 Board meeting schedule as presented in their Board packet.

Staff and Director's Reports

Director's Report

Executive Director Heidi Daniel referred trustees to her written report, noting that it was extensive for December. She announced that Library Outreach, Programs and Services Director Angie Benedetti will transition to the Collection Management Services Department as its director.

Heidi reported on a meeting with Renton Mayor Armondo Pavone and other city staff regarding the city's work with its unhoused population and to reaffirm the Library System's partnership in shared community spaces.

Heidi thanked trustees Laura Valenziano and Crystal Goodwin for attending the KCLS Annual Service Awards earlier in December. She also reported that KCLS staff met with Microsoft Elevate to explore a potential partnership, and that KCLS announced its annual Best Books list, a compilation of staff favorites from 2025.

Heidi reported that the KCLS Foundation launched the Love Letters campaign and exceeded its Giving Tuesday goal, raising \$56,000 against a \$50,000 target.



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She noted that KCLS surpassed 11 million digital circulations on OverDrive, exceeding last year's total, and reached 15,000 Instagram followers, representing a 50% increase since January 2025.

Heidi concluded her report by reviewing dashboard metrics, noting that the net promoter score remains strong at 88 and that other metrics are at or above last year's levels.

Board Committee Reports

Jeff Guddat, on behalf of the Finance Committee, thanked staff for the thoughtful and detailed information presented during the meeting.

Trustees Reports

Laura Valenziano shared that her daughter independently created a Love Letters to Libraries collection box at her school and received 30 letters from staff, parents, and students within four days, and distributed an additional 50 blank cards. Valenziano praised the campaign and thinks it will encourage positive reflection on and appreciation for libraries.

Adjournment

Laura Valenziano adjourned the meeting at 6:09pm.

Laura Valenziano, President

Jeff Guddat, Secretary
